

LI Yiran (李亦然)

CONTACT INFORMATION

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- 01/2023 - Present Assistant Professor, Department of Government and International Studies,
Hong Kong Baptist University (HKBU).
- 01/2019 - 12/2022 Assistant Professor, Department of Government and Public Administration,
University of Macau (UM).
Assistant Professor, Centre for Data Science, UM (concurrent appointment).

VISITING APPOINTMENTS

- 2026 Visiting Professor, Sciences Po Bordeaux, France. Invited to teach a three-week undergraduate course on Chinese politics, October 2026.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Digital Government and AI Governance, Public Policy, Chinese Politics, Computational Social Science.

EDUCATION

- 2014–2018 Doctor of Philosophy, Department of Politics and Public Administration,
The University of Hong Kong (HKU)
Dissertation title: *A Long March for Survival: The Internet, Social Media and Government Accountability in China* (Excellent Graduation)
- 2011–2013 Master of Philosophy, Division of Social Science,
The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)
- 2010–2011 Master of Arts, Division of Social Science,
The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
- 2006–2010 Bachelor of Laws, Department of International Politics,
Shanghai International Studies University
Shanghai Municipal Outstanding Graduate Awardee, 2010

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

1. Chen, Shuo, Yiran Li, and Yuzheng Wang. (2026) Artificial Intelligence and Punctuated Equilibrium: Shaping Government Attention in the Digital Age. *Public Administration Review*. Co-first author and corresponding author.
2. Li, Yiran, Yingying Fan, and Naim Kapucu. (2025). The Roles of High-Tech Companies in Collaborative Emergency Response Networks. *Public Management Review*. First author and corresponding author.
3. Li, Yiran, and Tao Li. (2025) The Effect of Spotlight on the Allocation of Voter Attention: Evidence from Block-Voting Ballots. *Political Studies*. 73(2), 523–546. First author.
4. Li, Yiran, Yingying Fan, and Lin Nie. (2025). Making Governance Agile: Exploring the Role of Artificial Intelligence in Local Governance of China. *Public Policy and Administration*. 40(2), 276–301. First author and corresponding author.
5. Li, Yiran, and Naim Kapucu. (2025). Determinants of the Use of Social Media in Crisis Communication: An Analysis of Microblogging by Chinese Local Government. *International Journal of Public Administration*. 48(2), 100–114. First author.
6. Chen, Shuo, Yiran Li. (2024). Accountability from Cyberspace? Scandal Exposure and Official Governance in China. *Political Science Research and Methods*. 12(1), 130–145. Corresponding Author.
7. Chen, Shuo, Yiran Li, and Xuanyi Wang. (2023). Trade Shocks and Urbanization: Evidence from County-level Data in China. *Applied Economics Letters*. 1–10. Corresponding Author.
8. Li, Yiran, Shuo Chen, and Peng Yaohui. (2023). In the Shadow of Administrative Decentralization: The Impact of Devolution on Subnational Service Provision. *American Review of Public Administration*. Vol 53(7–8):280–295. First Author. **2023 Best Policy Research Award by CPSG.**
9. Li, Yiran, Yanto Chandra, and Yingying Fan. (2022). Unpacking Government Social Media Messaging Strategies during COVID-19 Pandemic in China. *Policy & Internet*. Vol 14(3), 651–672. First author.
10. Chen, Shuo, Yiran Li, Guang Shi, and Zhitao Zhu. (2021). Gone with the Wind? Emissions of Neighboring Coal-fired Power Plants and Local Public Health in China. *China Economic Review*, Vol.69, 101660. Corresponding Author.
11. Li, Yiran, Yanto Chandra, Lin Nie, and Yingying Fan. (2020). From Women for Women: The Role of Social Media in Online Nonprofit Activities during Wuhan Lockdown. *Public Administration and Development*, Vol.40 (5), 267–272. First author and corresponding Author.
12. Li, Yiran, Yanto Chandra, and Naim Kapucu. (2020). Crisis Coordination and the Role of Social Media in Response to COVID-19 in Wuhan, China. *The American Review of Public Administration*, Vol.50 (6-7), 698–705. First author.

13. Chen, Shuo, Yiran Li, and Qin Yao. (2018). The Cost of Industrial Leap Forward in China: Evidence from SO₂ and Public Health. *China Economic Review*, Vol.49 (C), 68–83. Corresponding Author.

BOOK CHAPTER

- Li, Yiran. (2023). Cyberspace and Social Governance: the Role of Cyberspace Administration Office. In Ceren Ergenc, David Goodman (eds.), *Handbook on Local Governance in China: Structures, Variations, and Innovations*, Edward Elgar Publishing, Chapter 13.
- Li, Yiran. (2026). Policy Instrument Portfolios in AI Development: A Text Analysis of Chinese Policies. In Yanto Chandra, Michael Tsimplis, and Naikang Feng (eds.), *The Elgar Companion to Artificial Intelligence Governance: Exploring the Public Policy and Legal Landscape*, Edward Elgar Publishing, Chapter 3.

BOOK REVIEW

- Li, Yiran. (2019). Review of *Borders and Orders: Coastal and Maritime North-eastern South China Sea in the Sixteenth and Seventeenth Centuries*, by Boyi Chen. *H-Net Reviews*.

PUBLIC WRITING AND POLICY COMMENTARY

- Li, Yiran. (2026). “從治理議程之變到發展動能重構：五年規劃與香港融入國家發展大局的路徑演進” [From Policy Agenda Shifts to the Reconfiguration of Development Drivers: Five-Year Planning and Hong Kong’s Evolving Integration into National Development]. *Ta Kung Pao* / 大公報, June 12, 2026. Print edition; available online: [link](#).

COMPLETED PAPERS

- Visualizing the Sword and the Shield: The PLA’s Digital Publicity Strategy in Xi-era China. *The China Quarterly*. Under Review. Co-first author and corresponding author.
- Concept Measurement in the Age of Large Models: Theory-Based Coding in Multimodal Short-Video Data. *Social Science Computer Review*. Revise and Resubmit. Co-first author and corresponding author.
- Building China’s AI Agenda: Punctuated Equilibrium and the Dynamics of Government Attention. Submitted to *Policy Studies Journal*. First author and corresponding author.
- Generalists and Specialists in the Age of AI: Career Advancement in the Public Sector. Completed manuscript. Co-first author and corresponding author.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- The Digital Leviathan: Fiscal Centralization and Administrative Decentralization under Artificial Intelligence

- Rethinking Smart City Pathways: A Strategic—Relational Typology for Digital Transitions
- Agency, Embeddedness, and Risk: A Typological Framework for AI Governance

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND RESEARCH SUPPORT

- 2024 International Activities Grant, Hong Kong Baptist University. HKD 85,000.
- 2023 Best Policy Research Award, Chinese Policy Scholars Group. Awarded for “In the Shadow of Administrative Decentralization: The Impact of Devolution on Subnational Service Provision,” *American Review of Public Administration*.
- 2023 Start-up Research Grant, Hong Kong Baptist University.
- 2020–2026 Co-Investigator, *Strengthening the Executive-led System and Governance Capacity over the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region*, National Social Science Fund of China (NSSFC) Youth Project. RMB 200,000. Completed April 2026.
- 2019 Start-up Research Grant, University of Macau. MOP 150,000.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

For all courses, I served as sole instructor and course coordinator, with responsibility for curriculum and assessment design.

Department of Government and International Studies, HKBU

<i>Spring</i> 2023 – 2026	Instructor,	<i>Chinese Politics</i>
<i>Spring</i> 2022 – 2023	Instructor,	<i>Comparative Authoritarianism and Democratization</i>
<i>Fall</i> 2023 – 2026	Instructor,	<i>Theories of Public Administration</i> (MPA course)
<i>Spring</i> 2023 – 2026	Instructor,	<i>Public Policy and Governance</i> (MPA course)

Department of Government and Public Administration, UM

<i>Fall</i> 2019 – 2022	Instructor,	<i>Government Reform in China</i>
<i>Spring</i> 2019 – 2022	Instructor,	<i>Political Economy</i> (MPA course)
<i>Spring</i> 2019 – 2022	Instructor,	<i>Public Administration: Theory and Practice</i> (MPA course)
<i>Spring</i> 2022	Instructor,	<i>E-government and E-governance</i>

Small Group Teaching (Supervision) Experience

2012 – 2018	Tutor / Teaching Assistant (HKU & HKUST)
	<i>Led undergraduate discussion groups in Public Administration, Quantitative Methods, and Politics</i>

SERVICE

Selected Academic Leadership and Event Organization

- **Organizer, The Smart City Forum in the Greater Bay Area: Connected, Smart, Green, and Humanistic.** May 10, 2024.
Coordinated cross-regional stakeholders for high-impact forum on digital transition in the GBA.
Featured in: [China Daily](#), [China.com](#), [Media Coverage 1](#), [Media Coverage 2](#)
- **Organizer, HKBU-Shanghai University Joint Workshop on Regional and Area Studies,** Shanghai, June 3, 2024.
Facilitated institutional collaboration and knowledge exchange on China's regional development.

Selected Manuscript Referee

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| • Public Administration | • Applied Economics |
| • Public Management Review | • Applied Economics Letters |
| • International Public Management Journal | • China Economic Review |
| • Regulation & Governance | • Chinese Journal of Political Science |
| • Public Performance & Management Review | • China Information |
| • Review of Policy Research | • The China Journal |
| • Public Administration and Development | • The China Review |
| • Policy & Internet | • Chinese Political Science Review |
| • Journal of Urban Technology | • Social Media and Society |
| • Environmental Politics | • International Review of Administrative Sciences |
| • Political Behavior | • Sustainable Cities and Society |

Editorial and Journal Service

- **Young Editor,** *Asian Review of Political Economy*, 2023-2026.

Institutional and Departmental Governance (HKBU)

- Member, University Equal Opportunity Committee, 2023-Present
- Member, Advisory Committee on Equipment and Facility Enhancement, 2023-Present
- Member, Departmental Mainland Affairs Committee, 2023-Present

POSTGRADUATE STUDENTS SUPERVISED (SELECTED)

Primary supervisor of two current PhD candidates and supervisor of more than 20 completed master's students. The students listed below are selected examples.

PhD Students (Primary Supervisor)

Fan Yingying (2023–)

Liang Kaijie (2024–)

Master's Students (Selected; Completed)

Shi Zheng (2019–2021) MA in Public Administration, Excellent Graduation

Zhao Songyan (2019–2021) MA in Public Administration, Excellent Graduation

Yao Jiehan (2018–2020) MA in Public Administration, Excellent Graduation

SELECTED PRESENTATION AND INVITED TALKS

- 2026 Annual Conference of the American Society for Public Administration. Hollywood: Mar 2026.
- 2025 Public Management Research Conference. Seoul, Korea: Jun 2025.
- 2025 International Research Society for Public Management Annual Conference. Bologna, Italy: Apr 2025.
- 2024 AI and Public Policy International Conference. Singapore: Nov 2024.
- 2024 International Research Society for Public Management Annual Conference. Tampere, Finland: Apr 2024.
- 2023 Invited Talk at Shanghai University, Shanghai: Nov 2023.
- 2023 Global Urban Governance and Policy Studies Conference, Shanghai: Jul 2023.
- 2023 International Conference Automated Decision Making and Chinese Society, Australia(Hybrid): Feb 2023.
- 2022 Invited Talk at University of Chinese Academy of Social Sciences: Nov 2022.
- 2022 International Research Society for Public Management Annual Conference Online: Apr 2022.
- 2021 International Public Management Network Conference: Towards Good Government, Sustainability, Innovation and Social Equity, Korea(Online): Aug 2021.
- 2021 International Research Society for Public Management Annual Conference: Public Management, Governance, and Policy in Extraordinary Times: Challenges and Opportunities. Online: Apr 2021.
- 2021 The Asia Pacific Public Policy Network Annual Conference: Resilient and Inclusive Governance in the Age of Crisis. Online: Mar 2021.
- 2019 International Conference on Public Policy : Local Governance in A New Era:Opportunities, Challenges and Responses, Wuhan: Nov 2019.
- 2015 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, San Francisco: Sep 2015.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association, American Society for Public Administration

International Research Society for Public Management

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

COMPUTER SKILLS

- Proficient in statistical analysis and software(R and Stata),
- Proficient in natural language processing and programming (Python and Java),
- Basic use of Geographic Information Systems and related software(ArcGIS).